Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦2

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠9

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣J

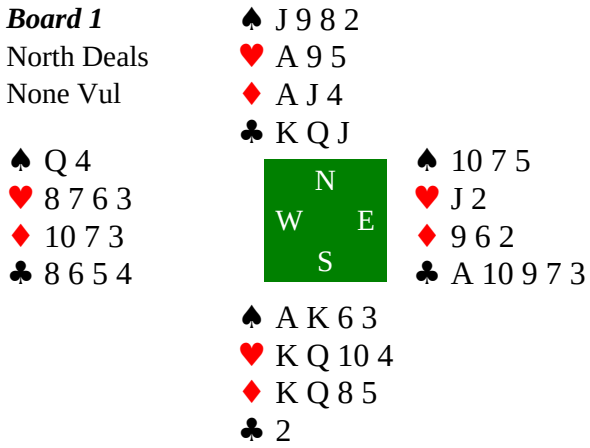
Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣J

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦4

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

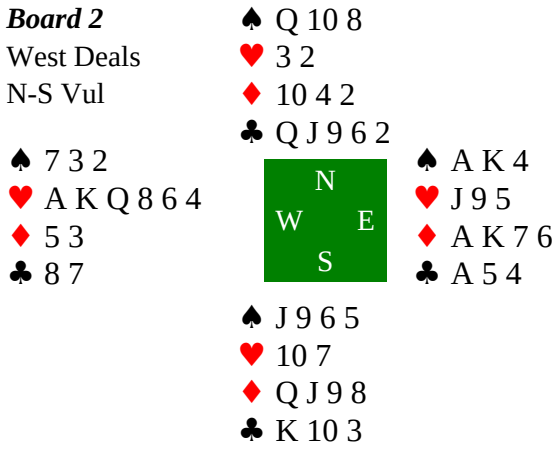
5♠ by North
Lead: ♦2

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, SOUTH uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time NORTH shows two Key Cards without the ♠Q.

Now SOUTH realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♦Q

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if EAST decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when WEST shows two Key Cards.

EAST has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking WEST to further describe his hand. WEST should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

WEST cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so EAST just passes 3NT.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K 5 3 ♥ A 9 5 2 ♦ 8 5 4 ♣ 6 5 4	
♠ 9 4 ♥ J 8 4 ♦ 9 7 6 ♣ K Q 9 8 2		♠ 10 7 ♥ 10 6 3 ♦ A 10 3 2 ♣ J 10 7 3
	♠ A Q J 8 6 2 ♥ K Q 7 ♦ K Q J ♣ A	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♠9

SOUTH realizes NORTH has fewer than 8 points, but the 3♠ support bid is enough for her to try a RKCB 4NT bid.

NORTH shows two Key Cards and SOUTH figures they will be the ♠K and one of the red Aces. So she bids 6♠. If instead the Key Cards are the two red Aces SOUTH might possibly make all thirteen tricks with a finesse.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 6 3 ♥ 10 9 3 ♦ A J 3 2 ♣ J 10 2	
♠ K Q J 5 ♥ A K 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A K Q		♠ A 7 2 ♥ Q 7 4 ♦ 9 8 5 ♣ 9 8 4 3
	♠ 9 8 4 ♥ J 8 ♦ K Q 10 7 4 ♣ 7 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]	Pass
5♦	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣J

EAST's 3♥ bid is "encouraging" so WEST bids 4NT.

When EAST shows one Key Card, (an Ace), WEST is afraid he may have a trump loser as well the other Ace. To find out about the ♥Q he bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

EAST has the ♥Q but no King so she jumps to 6♥.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K Q J 5 ♥ A K 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A K Q	
♠ 10 6 4 ♥ Q ♦ A K 10 9 3 2 ♣ 9 5 2		♠ 9 8 3 ♥ 10 3 ♦ Q J 7 4 ♣ J 10 7 6
	♠ A 7 2 ♥ J 9 8 7 4 ♦ 8 5 ♣ 8 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣J

This is the companion to Deal 22.

Again, worried about a possible trump loser in addition to the missing Ace, NORTH bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

SOUTH definitely does NOT have the ♥Q. But with five trumps she does know that NORTH probably does not have a trump loser so she jumps to 6♥ anyway.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 10 4 ♥ 3 2 ♦ A 10 5 ♣ Q J 9 4 2	
♠ A K 9 6 3 ♥ A J 7 5 ♦ K Q 2 ♣ 6	N W E S	♠ 8 5 ♥ K Q 9 6 4 ♦ 7 3 ♣ A K 8 5
	♠ J 7 2 ♥ 10 8 ♦ J 9 8 6 4 ♣ 10 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by East
Lead: ♦4

WEST cannot use RKCB at her second bid because trumps have not been agreed. So she bids 3♥ to set trumps, knowing EAST cannot pass after her jump-shift.

EAST tries to stop at game but WEST is too strong so she now uses RKCB and gets to 6♥ when EAST shows two Key Cards and the trump Queen.